

Task 1 Acceptable Use Policy

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Objective

Create a complete Acceptable Use Policy (AUP) for a fictional company.

Scenario

Company: TechSecure Solutions Inc.

Industry: Software Development

Employees: 500

Locations: 3 offices + remote workers

Systems: Cloud-based development environment, corporate email, VPN, collaboration tools

The company has recently experienced:

- Employees using work email for personal purposes
- Unauthorized software installations
- Social media posts about confidential projects
- Personal devices connecting to the corporate network without approval

Management has requested a comprehensive AUP to address these issues.

Requirements

Create an AUP that covers ALL of the following areas:

1. **Internet Usage** - browsing rules, personal use, monitoring
 2. **Email Usage** - acceptable use, retention
 3. **Software** - approved software, installation procedures
 4. **Social Media** - confidentiality, company representation
 5. **BYOD** - registration, security requirements
 6. **Data Handling** - storage, sharing, disposal
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Deliverables

- Complete AUP document.

Include: policy header, purpose, scope, enforcement, consequences, acknowledgment section.

Acceptable Use Policy

Document Control

Field	Value
Policy ID	POL-AUP-001
Version	1.0
Effective Date	2026-06-22
Review Date	2027-06-22
Policy Owner	Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)
Approved By	Executive Management Committee
Classification	Internal

1. Purpose

This policy establishes requirements for the acceptable use of TechSecure Solutions Inc.'s information systems, networks, and digital resources to ensure security, protect confidential data, and maintain productivity while allowing reasonable business-related personal use.

The policy specifically addresses recent concerns including unauthorized software installations, improper handling of confidential information on social media, unsecured personal device connections, and excessive personal use of corporate email systems.

2. Scope

2.1 Applicability

This policy applies to:

- All employees (full-time, part-time, temporary)
- Contractors and consultants
- Third-party vendors with system access
- Former employees until access is formally revoked

2.2 Systems/Assets Covered

• Corporate email systems • Cloud-based development environments • Virtual Private Network (VPN) infrastructure • Collaboration tools (Slack, Teams, project management platforms) • Corporate computers, laptops, and servers • Networks (wired, wireless, cloud infrastructure) • Any company-provided or company-owned devices • Company intellectual property and data regardless of storage location

2.3 Exclusions

- Customer-facing production systems governed by separate service agreements
 - Development sandbox environments explicitly marked as non-production
 - Personal devices used solely for personal purposes (no corporate data)
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3. Policy Statements

3.1 Internet Usage

Employees must use internet resources responsibly and securely at all times.

Requirements:

- **Browsing Rules:** Access only websites necessary for business purposes. Prohibited sites include malware distribution, phishing sources, gambling, adult content, and illegal file-sharing services.
- **Personal Use:** Limited personal browsing is permitted during break times and must not interfere with work responsibilities or consume more than 5% of bandwidth during peak hours.
- **Monitoring:** All internet activity on corporate systems may be monitored, logged, and audited for security compliance. No expectation of privacy exists when using company resources.

3.2 Email Usage

Corporate email must be used primarily for business communications with appropriate security standards.

Requirements:

- **Acceptable Use:** Work email is intended for business communications. Limited personal correspondence is permitted but must not involve sensitive topics, marketing spam, or commercial activities.
- **Retention:** All emails are retained for 7 years per regulatory requirements. Do not store confidential customer data in email unless encrypted.
- **Forwarding Restrictions:** Forwarding external email to personal accounts requires CISO approval. Automatically forwarding company email to personal addresses is prohibited.

3.3 Software Installation

Only approved software may be installed on company systems.

Requirements:

- **Approved Software:** Maintain installation only from the company's centralized software repository. All other software requires security team review and approval.
- **Installation Procedures:** Submit Software Request Form to IT Security Team minimum 48 hours before planned installation. Emergency installations require post-approval within 24 hours.

- **Prohibited Software:** Peer-to-peer file sharing, remote access tools without authorization, cryptocurrency miners, screen recorders, keyloggers, cracked/pirated software, and unapproved virtualization tools.

3.4 Social Media

Social media use must protect company confidentiality and reputation.

Requirements:

- **Confidentiality:** Never discuss active projects, code repositories, security vulnerabilities, client information, or internal systems on social media platforms.
- **Company Representation:** When posting content identifying yourself as a TechSecure employee, include disclaimers stating opinions are your own.
- **Security Awareness:** Be aware of social engineering attacks via social platforms. Verify identities before sharing any technical or organizational details.

3.5 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

Personal devices accessing corporate resources require registration and security compliance.

Requirements:

- **Registration:** All personal devices must register through MDM portal before connecting to corporate network. Unregistered device access is prohibited.
- **Security Requirements:** Minimum 6-digit passcode, encryption enabled, automatic lock after 5 minutes of inactivity, latest OS version, approved endpoint protection software installed.
- **Usage Restrictions:** Company data on personal devices must remain segregated. Wipe capability required upon termination or policy violation.

3.6 Data Handling

All company data must be properly classified, stored, shared, and disposed of according to security requirements.

Requirements:

- **Storage:** Sensitive data must be stored only on approved secure systems. Local storage on laptops requires full disk encryption. Never store confidential data on personal cloud services.
- **Sharing:** Use encrypted file transfer methods for sensitive data externally. Sharing credentials is prohibited; use secure password management instead.
- **Disposal:** Secure deletion required for all media containing company data. Hard drives must be physically destroyed or cryptographically erased before disposal.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Executive	Approve policy, allocate resources, demonstrate commitment, support

Role	Responsibilities
Management	enforcement
CISO / IT Security Team	Implement controls, monitor compliance, conduct audits, report violations, maintain approved software list
Department Managers	Ensure team compliance, report issues, support training completion, verify BYOD registration
All Employees	Comply with policy, report incidents immediately, complete annual security training, register personal devices
IT Operations	Provide technical support, implement monitoring systems, maintain logging infrastructure

5. Compliance

5.1 Monitoring

Compliance will be monitored through:

- Automated log analysis and anomaly detection systems
- Regular review of email metadata and web traffic patterns
- Quarterly vulnerability scans of registered devices
- Random spot checks of software installations
- Social media monitoring for potential data leaks

5.2 Reporting

Monthly compliance reports submitted to Executive Management. Violations discovered must be reported to security@techsecure-solutions.com within 24 hours of discovery.

5.3 Auditing

Annual third-party security audit required. Internal quarterly audits conducted by IT Security Team. Audit logs retained for 3 years minimum.

6. Enforcement

6.1 Violations

Violations of this policy may result in:

- Verbal warning (first minor offense)
- Written warning (repeat or moderate offense)
- Suspension of network/access privileges (immediate for serious violations)
- Disciplinary action up to and including termination
- Legal action where applicable (data breaches, theft, fraud)

6.2 Reporting Violations

Report suspected violations to: security@techsecure-solutions.com or anonymously through Ethics Hotline at 1-800-XXX-XXXX

Whistleblower protections apply to good-faith reports.

7. Exceptions

7.1 Exception Process

Exceptions to this policy require:

1. Written request to CISO or Policy Owner
2. Detailed business justification explaining necessity
3. Risk assessment conducted by Security Team
4. Compensating controls documented and implemented (if applicable)
5. Formal approval and documentation in exception registry
6. Regular re-evaluation at defined intervals

7.2 Exception Duration

All exceptions must have a defined end date and be reviewed quarterly. Maximum initial exception duration is 6 months unless extended with renewed risk assessment.

8. Definitions

Term	Definition
BYOD	Bring Your Own Device - personal computing devices used to access corporate resources
Confidential Data	Information designated as proprietary, client-related, or security-sensitive
Corporate Systems	Any hardware, software, or network resource owned or managed by TechSecure Solutions Inc.
Encryption	Cryptographic encoding of data to prevent unauthorized access
MDM	Mobile Device Management - system for managing and securing mobile devices
Malware	Malicious software including viruses, worms, trojans, ransomware

9. Related Documents

• Information Security Policy (POL-ISP-001) • Data Classification Standard (STD-DCC-001) • Incident Response Procedure (PROC-IR-001) • Remote Work Policy (POL-RW-001) • NIST Cybersecurity Framework • SOC 2 Type II Compliance Requirements

10. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description
1.0	2026-06-22	Security Committee	Initial release

11. Acknowledgment

By accessing company systems, all users acknowledge they have read, understood, and agree to comply with this policy.

For formal acknowledgment tracking, use the company's policy acknowledgment system at <https://intranet.techsecure-solutions.com/policy-acknowledgments>